

POSITIONING, MESSAGING & ICP: UNDECIDED — THAT'S THE OUTPUT WE'RE HIRING FOR. This is the input pack: what the product is and does, every feature with its "why it matters" seed, differentiation raw material, audience facts and hypotheses, and claim guardrails. Internal beliefs are labeled as beliefs — challenge them. **Note:** pricing/packaging is a separate, parallel engagement and is also undecided — avoid hard-coding tiers, plan names, or prices in messaging for now.

1 · WHAT BASEOUT IS

Baseout is the **backup, restore, and data intelligence layer for Airtable**. It automatically backs up everything in a customer's Airtable estate — schema, records, attachments, and (via guided submission) automations and interfaces — to storage the *customer* controls or to Baseout-managed storage. It restores any of it, point-in-time, without ever overwriting live data. And on top of the backup pipeline it builds what Airtable itself doesn't offer: an auto-generated visual map of your schema, a change history of everything, a health score for every base, documentation tooling, and a live SQL copy of your data you can query directly.

Elevator pitch on file (a starting point, not a mandate): "Baseout is the backup, restore, and data intelligence layer for Airtable — giving platform admins real-time protection, schema visibility, and direct SQL access to their own data."

Business context — an established player relaunching, not a cold start

Baseout is the full rebrand and next-generation replacement of **On2Air Backups**, a known name in the Airtable ecosystem with **~200 paying customers** who will migrate to Baseout. For GTM this means: (1) **existing brand equity and community trust** to transfer — and a legacy base whose migration must feel like an upgrade, not a rug-pull; (2) **real usage history** — we know what actual Airtable admins back up, how often, and how big their estates are (data available for ICP work); (3) **a proven but thin category** — customers already pay for Airtable backup, the closest competitor went out of business, and Airtable's own snapshots are the "do nothing" default.

Where it's going (V2 trajectory — vision material, not launch claims)

Multi-platform Spaces (Airtable + Notion + HubSpot under one roof) · an MCP server and RAG pipeline exposing the customer's data layer to AI assistants · a governance/compliance suite · third-party connectors (Zapier, Make). Positioning should have room for this arc without leaning on it at launch.

2 · THE PROBLEMS IT SOLVES (BENEFIT RAW MATERIAL)

Four distinct jobs-to-be-done, each with its own emotional register. A messaging hierarchy will lead with one and support with the others — **which one leads is an ICP decision**.

JOB	THE PAIN, IN THE CUSTOMER'S WORDS	REGISTER	BENEFIT SEED
Insurance	"One wrong click — by me or anyone — and years of work is gone. Airtable's undo only goes so far."	Fear, responsibility	<i>Sleep at night. Every base, backed up on schedule, restorable in minutes.</i>
Governance / ownership	"Best practice (and our auditors) say a backup that lives inside the vendor isn't a backup. Snapshots don't count."	Duty, professionalism	<i>A true external copy — in YOUR storage if you want.</i>
Visibility	"Our Airtable grew organically for 4 years. Nobody knows what's connected to what, what's dead, or what changed."	Overwhelm → mastery	<i>See your whole schema as a living diagram. Know what changed, when, and how healthy every base is.</i>
Data liberation	"Our data is trapped in Airtable's format. I want SQL, BI tools, to build on it."	Frustration → empowerment	<i>A live SQL database of your own data. Query it, connect it, build on it.</i>

Structural note: the first two jobs are served by **static** backup (files to storage); the last two require **dynamic** backup (a hosted database copy). The modes carry opposite privacy stories — static/BYOS is "we never store your data"; dynamic is "let us host a copy and we'll make it superpowered." Both are true and both are marketed; they must never collide in one sentence (§4).

3 · COMPLETE FEATURE INVENTORY

Status flags what marketing can promise at launch:  shipped ·  partial/in-progress ·  **committed V1, in build** ·  V2 roadmap. Feature-to-plan assignment is provisional everywhere (pricing engagement in flight).

3.1 Backup (the core)

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	WHY IT MATTERS (BENEFIT SEED)	STATUS
Scheduled backups	Automatic runs — monthly, weekly, daily; "instant" (webhook-driven, near-real-time) tops the range	Set-and-forget protection; cadence = how little you can afford to lose	 (instant SOON)
Manual on-demand runs	One-click "back up now"	Pre-flight ritual: back up, then break things safely	
Full-fidelity capture	Schema (tables, fields, views), all records, all attachments; deduped attachment handling	A complete copy — structure and files — not a CSV shadow	
Automations & interfaces backup	Airtable's API doesn't expose these; guided intake (forms, scripts, inbound API) captures and versions them	The parts you <i>can't</i> rebuild from memory are exactly what Airtable won't export	 SOON
Multi-base + auto-discovery	Connect once, select bases, optionally auto-add future bases	Coverage doesn't rot as the estate grows	
Storage destinations	Google Drive, Dropbox, Box, OneDrive, Baseout-managed (Cloudflare R2); S3, Frame.io, custom BYOS coming	Backups land where <i>you</i> live. Only vendor with OneDrive.	 (S3 SOON)
BYOS privacy posture	On static backups to customer-owned storage, record data streams through memory — never stored on Baseout servers	"We back up your data without ever keeping it." A genuine trust differentiator	
Backup audit trail	Per-run report (captured / skipped / errored), per-entity verification, run-history dashboard	Trust but verify — proof the backup worked, every time	
Retention & smart cleanup	Keep snapshots per policy (daily for 30d, then weekly...); automated pruning	History without hoarding; governance-grade retention	 SOON
Real-time progress	Live backup progress on the dashboard	Watching it work builds trust in an insurance product	 SOON

3.2 Restore

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	WHY IT MATTERS	STATUS
Point-in-time restore, base- or table-level	Restore a whole base or single table from any retained snapshot	"Get me back to Tuesday" — surgical, not all-or-nothing	 SOON
Never overwrites + verification	Restores always create a <i>new</i> base/table; record-count validation after	Zero-risk recovery — you can't make the incident worse	 SOON
AI-assisted restore guidance	For entities that can't auto-restore (automations, interfaces), curated AI prompts walk through reconstruction	Even the "unrestorable" parts have a path back	

3.3 Schema intelligence

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	WHY IT MATTERS	STATUS
Schema visualization	Auto-generated, always-current ERD/node graph of every base — tables, fields, relationships	The "whoa" demo moment. Nobody has ever <i>seen</i> their Airtable before	
Pre-signup schema visualization	OAuth in and see your schema diagram before creating an account	The top-of-funnel hook: instant value, zero commitment	→ SOON
Schema changelog	Human-readable history: "Field X was deleted on March 12"	Answers "what changed?" — the first question after anything breaks	→ SOON
Base health score	0–100 audit grade per base (orphaned fields, missing descriptions, circular lookups, formula errors); configurable rules	Turns "our base is a mess" into a number you can improve — and a consultant deliverable	→ SOON
Schema documentation	Rich-text docs with tags pinned to tables/fields/views, links, embedded mini-diagrams	The missing wiki for your Airtable architecture	
AI-generated documentation	AI writes field/table descriptions and schema summaries	Documentation that writes itself	→ SOON
Diagram export	PNG/SVG/PDF, embeddable widget	Diagrams that travel — decks, docs, client reports	

3.4 Data intelligence (requires the hosted database copy)

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	WHY IT MATTERS	STATUS
Record metrics & growth trends	Record counts per table/base over time, storage growth	See the estate growing before it becomes a problem	→ SOON
Data changelog	History of record-level changes	Forensics: who-changed-what, over months	→ SOON
Data alerts & PII detection	Rules ("alert if this table drops below N records"); scans for personally identifiable information	The smoke alarm, not just the insurance policy; compliance radar	
Analytics & reports	Dashboards, scheduled reports, exports	Estate reporting for stakeholders	

3.5 Access & integration (requires the hosted database copy)

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	WHY IT MATTERS	STATUS
Live SQL database of your data	Airtable data continuously synced into a real database (SQLite → PostgreSQL ladder; enterprise can bring their own DB)	The unlock: SQL, BI tools, apps — <i>on your</i> data, outside Airtable's limits	→ SOON
SQL REST API + direct SQL access	Query over HTTPS with a token, or plug in a real connection string	psql, Metabase, Grafana, scripts — one line to your data	→ SOON
Inbound API	Documented public API to push data Airtable's API doesn't expose; agent/AI-friendly	The estate's missing pieces get a front door	→ SOON
MCP server / RAG / chatbot	Expose the data layer to AI assistants; hosted chatbot grounded in the customer's data	"Ask your Airtable questions" — the AI-era story	
Zapier / Make connectors, outbound webhooks	Event-driven integrations	Backup events join the automation fabric	

3.6 Governance (V2 — vision material only): data quality rules, classification, lineage, retention policies, access controls, audit trail, PII scanning, SOC 2/GDPR tooling. Enterprise-vision slides, not launch claims.

3.7 Experience & trust surface

FEATURE	NOTES	STATUS
Passwordless sign-in, no card to start	Magic-link auth; friction-free trial entry	✓
7-day free trial with a real backup run	Try-before-buy on the customer's actual data (trial shape may change with pricing work)	✓
Mobile-responsive web app	Status checks from anywhere	✓
Runs embedded inside Airtable	Baseout as an Airtable interface extension, context-aware to the base you're viewing	→ SOON
Guided tours & tooltips	Onboarding wizard, first-backup tour	→ SOON
Notifications	Email + in-app for everyone; Slack, outbound webhooks, Teams, PagerDuty up the range	🔔 (email ✓)
Encryption	AES-256-GCM for stored credentials; encryption at rest everywhere Baseout hosts data	✓
SOC 2	In progress (audit runway from ~Apr 2026). "SOC 2 in progress" is claimable; "certified" is NOT yet	🔔
GDPR / DPAs	Planned from day one; required before hosted-data plans launch	🔔
SSO (SAML), 2FA	Enterprise auth	→ SOON

4 · DIFFERENTIATION RAW MATERIAL

The competitive frame

ALTERNATIVE	REALITY	ANGLE AVAILABLE TO US
Airtable native snapshots	Free, built-in, and the default "we're covered" belief	The core objection to beat: snapshots live <i>inside</i> Airtable, restore whole-base only, expire, and satisfy no external-copy governance requirement. "A backup your vendor holds for you is a promise, not a backup."
Sync Inc	Out of business	Category cautionary tale; our multi-year, 200-customer history is the counter
Whalesync / Coefficient	Marketing-sync niche / spreadsheet sync	Neither is a backup or schema intelligence; we stay general-purpose
DIY scripts	Common among exactly our most technical buyers	"You could build it. You shouldn't have to maintain it." Fidelity (attachments, rate limits, retries) is where DIY quietly fails

Claims inventory — verify every "only" before print

- **Only backup solution focused exclusively on Airtable** — depth story: field types, rate limits, attachment-expiry quirks handled natively.
- **Most storage destinations of any vendor; the only one supporting OneDrive.**
- **Only vendor offering both bring-your-own-storage AND bring-your-own-database** — competitors are consolidating onto their own hosted storage.
- **On static/BYOS plans, customer record data is never stored on Baseout servers.** Must always be scoped to static/BYOS mode — as a blanket claim it would be false for dynamic customers.
- **Only solution turning Airtable into a live SQL layer** (post-Sync Inc); scope carefully against sync products.
- **Restore never overwrites live data** — safety claim, uncontested.

The static-vs-dynamic tension: the privacy claim (static) and hosted-SQL claim (dynamic) are both flagship differentiators describing opposite data postures. Working frame: *customer choice* — "your data, your rules: keep it fully external, or let us host a copy and make it queryable." **Trust assets:** ~200 paying customers and years of operating history, encryption everywhere, provable per-run audit reports. **Liabilities to manage:** the rebrand itself (continuity messaging so the community doesn't read "shutdown"), SOC 2 not yet certified, several headline features (restore!) still in build — \$6 claim hygiene.

5 · AUDIENCE RAW MATERIAL (FOR THE ICP DECISION)

The persona on file: the Airtable Platform Admin

The person responsible for building, managing, and protecting an organization's Airtable infrastructure: internal IT managers, RevOps/BizOps owners, and **independent Airtable consultants managing multiple client accounts**. Manages one or more workspaces on behalf of an organization or clients; needs reliable, auditable, low-maintenance backup; cares about data integrity, schema visibility, fast recovery. **Technically capable** — comfortable with OAuth, storage configuration, SQL. Extends naturally to Notion/HubSpot/Salesforce admins as platforms are added (V2). Secondary personas (V2): developers building on the SQL layer; enterprise IT/compliance officers.

Segment sketches (hypotheses to validate, not conclusions)

SEGMENT	SHAPE	LEADING JOB (\$2)	NOTES
Solo / small-team ops admin	1 org, a few bases	Insurance	Bulk of the legacy base; price-sensitive; wants simple
Airtable consultant / agency	Many client orgs	Visibility + Insurance	High-leverage: one convinced consultant deploys us across every client; health scores and diagrams are <i>their</i> client deliverables; potential channel/referral motion
RevOps / BizOps at a scale-up	Airtable business-critical	Data liberation + Insurance	Wants frequency, retention, SQL for BI, Slack alerts
Enterprise IT / compliance	Governance mandates	Governance	Needs SOC 2 (pending), SSO, BYODB; not marketable at scale until certification lands

What the existing ~200 customers tell us

They bought a **static backup product** — scheduled file backups to their own cloud storage — skewing smaller/simpler. Plan mix, base counts, and volumes are available on request: **the single best empirical input for the ICP decision**. Two cautions: (a) the legacy base may over-represent the "insurance" job simply because that's all On2Air sold — don't let it cap the ambition; (b) their migration experience is itself a GTM moment (§6).

Buying-trigger hypotheses (validate in interviews)

1. A deletion incident or near-miss ("someone deleted a table last week").	2. A compliance/security review, their own SOC 2 audit, or an enterprise customer questionnaire: "how is this data backed up?"
3. A new admin inherits a sprawling, undocumented estate (visibility need spikes).	4. A consultant standardizing their client stack.
5. A BI/reporting project hits Airtable's API and format limits (SQL need).	6. Airtable pricing/packaging changes prompt "how portable is our data?" audits.

Where to find them (hypotheses)

The Airtable Community forum · r/airtable · the BuiltOnAir ecosystem (podcast/community) · Airtable consultant directories and agency networks · no-code communities · the planned **Airtable Marketplace listing** (organic discovery). The existing On2Air footprint in these spaces is an asset to inherit deliberately rather than let lapse in the rebrand.

6 · MESSAGING INGREDIENTS & PRACTICAL TIPS

Funnel mechanics already in the product

Pre-signup schema visualization is the designed hook: OAuth in, see your schema diagram, *then* hit "Start backing up your data" — value in 60 seconds, zero commitment. **Passwordless magic-link signup, no credit card** — friction claims are legitimate. **The trial runs a real backup on the customer's own data** — "see your actual data protected" beats a demo (trial shape may change with pricing work; keep copy flexible). The product will also **run embedded inside Airtable** as an extension (in build) — meet users where they already are.

Tone & design direction (decided product-side; messaging should match)

The product is deliberately a **professional operations console**: functional over decorative, information-dense, trust signals first (backup status, last run, success/failure always visible), power over simplicity. The audience is technical and accountable. Messaging that reads like a consumer lifestyle product will clash with the product experience. Think: calm, competent, specific; numbers and receipts over adjectives.

Vocabulary guardrails (canonical naming — used in product, docs, and API)

TERM	RULE
Organization	The customer/billing entity — not "account" or "company" in formal copy
Space	Our container where backup config lives — chosen to avoid Airtable's own "Workspace" term. Never say "Workspace" for our container
Platform · Connection	Airtable (later Notion...) · an authenticated link to a platform
Base / Table / Field / Record / Attachment	Airtable's own terms, mirrored exactly
Backup Run vs. Backup Snapshot	An execution vs. the stored result. Restore always creates new data
Static vs. Dynamic backup	Files to a Storage Destination vs. into a database. Mode names for technical copy; whether they surface in marketing is your call, but the <i>concepts</i> must not blur
BYOS / BYODB · Storage Destination	Bring your own storage / database · where backup files land
Brand	"Baseout" in prose (capital B, one word); logo mark is lowercase "baseout"

The legacy-migration narrative (a launch-critical audience of ~200)

On2Air customers move to Baseout via a guided re-auth flow. Internal draft messaging emphasizes: *static backups work exactly the same — same destinations, same process; no more artificial limits; new capabilities await when you're ready*. Pricing commitments for this cohort belong to the pricing engagement — **coordinate the two workstreams so the migration email says one coherent thing**. The rebrand announcement is also a community moment (ecosystem podcasts, forums) — "On2Air grew up" is a story, not just a notice.

CLAIM HYGIENE (LEGAL/ACCURACY GUARDRAILS) — **(1)** Never claim SOC 2 *certified* until it is; "SOC 2 in progress" is the approved formulation. **(2)** Scope the privacy claim ("never stores your data") to static/BYOS mode explicitly. **(3)** Restore, retention, instant backup, the SQL layer, and most intelligence features are *still in build* — launch copy must track the §3 status flags or clearly mark "coming soon." **(4)** V2 items (MCP/RAG, governance, connectors, multi-platform) are vision-tier only — roadmap slides yes, feature pages no. **(5)** Verify every "only vendor that..." claim against the current market before print.

Analytics & attribution already planned: PostHog (product analytics, funnels, session replay) and dub.co (referral/affiliate tracking, migrating from Rewardful — existing affiliate links must keep working) — campaign measurement and a referral program have plumbing on the roadmap.

7 · WHAT WE'RE ASKING YOU TO DETERMINE

1. ICP — which segment(s) from §5 lead; firmographic + role definition; the wedge vs. the expansion audiences.	2. Positioning — category framing ("Airtable backup" vs. "Airtable data platform" vs. something else), and the primary job (§2) the brand leads with.
3. Messaging hierarchy — headline value prop, supporting pillars, proof points; how the static-privacy and dynamic-SQL stories coexist without collision (§4).	4. Feature → benefit packaging — turn §3 into benefit-led marketing architecture (site sections, one-liners per capability).
5. Launch narrative — the rebrand/relaunch story arc: legacy-customer communication, community announcement, new-customer campaign, Marketplace listing copy.	6. Objection handling — especially "Airtable already has snapshots" and "we have a script for that."
7. Channel hypotheses to test — from §5.5 plus your own; the role of consultants as a channel.	

Constraints to work within: claim hygiene per §6; canonical vocabulary per §6; pricing/tiers unavailable until the pricing engagement lands; SOC 2 timing gates enterprise-facing campaigns.

8 · MATERIALS AVAILABLE ON REQUEST

- On2Air customer roster and usage data (plans, tenure, estate sizes) — the best empirical ICP input we have.
- Full product spec set: PRD (vision, personas, UX direction), Features spec (capability matrices, naming dictionary), implementation plan.
- Brand assets and guidelines (*brand/* directory), including the existing marketing-site draft.
- Access to the working product (dev environment) for first-hand experience of the shipped surface.
- The parallel pricing-engagement inputs pack (*overview/pricing/*) — shares the segment and cost analyses; coordinate ICP and pricing assumptions.